

017. Chapter 2 Verses 47

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.47

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन ।
मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि ॥ 47 ॥

karmaṇyevādhikāraṣte
mā phaleṣu kadācana |
mā karmaphalaheturbhūr
mā te saṅgo'stvakarmaṇi ||

◆ karmaṇi – in action; eva – only; adhikāraḥ – right; te – your; ◆ mā – never; phaleṣu – in fruits; kadācana – at any time; ◆ mā – not; karma-phala-hetuḥ – cause of the fruit of action; bhūḥ – be; ◆ mā – not; te – your; saṅgaḥ – attachment; astu – let there be; akarmaṇi – in inaction.

You have the right to work only, and not to the fruits of work. Let not the fruit of action be your motive, nor let your attachment be to inaction.